Diego Llanes

Seattle, WA, USA

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ABOUT ME

I am a Machine Learning Engineer with expertise in building large-scale datasets to develop and deploy computer vision and large language model solutions – I am passionate about making tools people actually use.

EDUCATION

Western Washington University, Bellingham, WA, USA *Sep 2024 - Jun 2025*
Master of Science in Computer Science 3.9 GPA

Western Washington University, Bellingham, WA, USA *Jan 2021 - Jun 2024*
Bachelor of Science in Computer Science 3.6 GPA

EXPERIENCE

Machine Learning Engineer II *Seattle, WA*
Expedia Group *October 2025 - Present*

- Owned and operated a recommendation service that handled ~2k RPS peak and scaled dynamically.
- Developed "Rare Find" indicators on live site which lead to an increase of 2% uplift in bookings.
- Trained message relevancy models to improve customer likelihood of responding to push notifications.

Contract Collaborator *Seattle, WA*
Allen Institute for Artificial Intelligence (AI2) *May 2025 - October 2025*

- Created a visual grounding dataset of ~400k screenshots for OCR pretraining of vision language models.
- Filtered dataset to include only successful training samples which improved overall model accuracy by 15%.
- Aided in development of a human data collection tool for collecting real web trajectories of web tasks.

Scientific Machine Learning Masters Intern *Seattle, WA, USA*
Pacific Northwest National Laboratory *June 2023 - May 2025*

- Added features to an open-source project which attracted new users from other domains to our project.
- Built automated experiment pipelines for batch deployment using Slurm allowing for rapid result analysis.
- Developed a strong foundation in control theory, deep reinforcement learning and Generative-AI.

PROJECTS / PUBLICATIONS

Web Agents Summer 2025
Allen Institute for Artificial Intelligence (AI2)

- Developed a vision based multimodal agent to autonomously execute end-to-end complex web tasks.
- Created open source web navigation datasets to accelerate community research of autonomous web agents.
- The manuscript for this work has been submitted to ECCV, the tech report and demos can be found here.

STARS: Sensor-agnostic Transformer Architecture for Remote Sensing Summer 2024
Pacific Northwest National Laboratory

- Developed a vision model that accepts an arbitrary count of spectral measurements, agnostic to sensor.
- Created a Web GUI front end for the visualization and deployment of experiments for domain experts.
- *This work was presented at IEEE Whispers 2024 conference.*

BOSS Net: A Self-consistent Data-driven Model for Determining Stellar Parameters Fall 2023
Hutchinson Research Group

- Built a CNN to estimate the surface gravity and temperature of stars from near-infrared photometry.
- Released a self consistent 412k spectral training corpus by labelling points from a multitude of sensors.
- *This work was presented at the 2023 SDSS-V Collaboration Meeting and published in the Astronomical Journal.*

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, Kotlin, SQL, JavaScript, Go, Java, C, HTML + CSS

Libraries / Tools: PyTorch, vLLM, HF | Springboot, Flask, BentoML | Docker, K8s, ELK, Jenkins | S3, EC2, λ